Jodie Raymond Originals

CROCHET TRIMS FOR KNITS

BASIC CROCHET

SWATCHING

Simple and easy directions of basic Crochet work. Directions for Crochet trims are included to enhance the finishing details for all your knits. Swatches for both Knitting and Crochet Work are explained in detail for correct sizing of garments.

"It's The Finishing Touch That Makes Good Items - GREAT".

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ISBN: 0-939669-16-1

First Printing - January, 1993.

The instructions and explanations have been carefully written and are believed to be clear, complete and accurate. Any misunderstandings, or adaptations, are solely the responsibility of the owner of the book.

FORWARD

To enjoy the art of knitting and crocheting requires many talents. Of course, one must be able to knit, crochet, and/or use a knitting machine. You must also have the right yarn to create the desired results. Colors and patterning must also be suitable and appealing. But, correct finishing and sizing of any article can end up being the most essential ingredients for the complete satisfaction of your accomplishments.

In working with many knitters, it has been observed that the Crochet finishing on many of my garments has been noticed. Lots of individuals have said they can knit, but have difficulty with crochet work. So, this is my effort to show all of you how easy crocheting is done. Just a little practice and you're a pro.

After you have mastered the basic steps of crochet, try some of the easy trims that are included in this book to enhance your knitted garments. A few of my favorite edgings, along with some decorative stitches, are described for you to enjoy.

Another benefit of learning to crochet is to repair or correct major and minor disasters. There are a few tricks with crochet work to correct some unwanted happenings of a knit. For instance, if an opening of a neck, or cuff, become a little too large - crocheting around the edges can reduce the size quite a bit. If a hem or edge of a knit doesn't hang or lay properly, crochet work can stabilize the fabric for you. Try crocheting a casing for elastic to draw in a knit at the waistline or wrist. Being able to do basic crochet will help you in many ways.

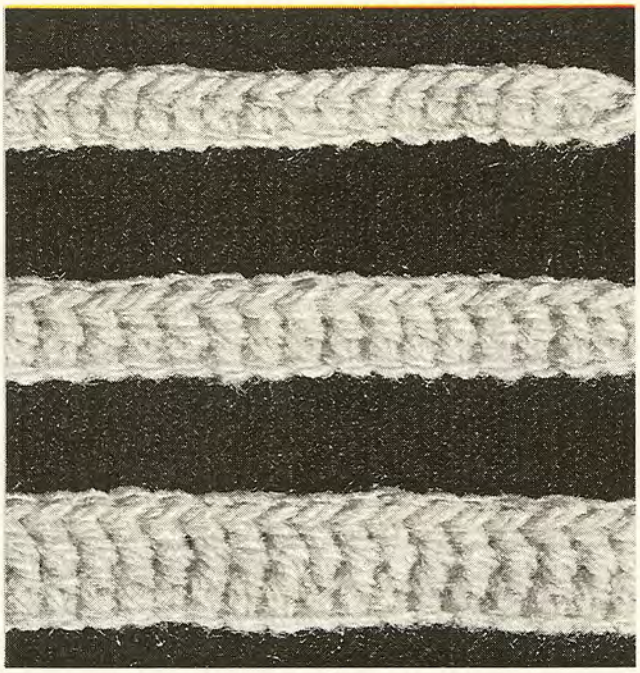
One other pet peeve of many knitters is making a Swatch and reading it correctly. Disliking to make a Swatch as much as most of you, I set out early in my knitting career to try and figure out the easiest way to accomplish this disagreeable task. Like you, with a limited supply of yarn - the wasting of yarn in making a bunch of wrong Swatches had to be avoided at all costs. It took quite a lot of effort but the result has been a fast, easy, small Swatch that gives one a lot of information. This I would like to share with you. Swatches are vital to the enjoyment of knitting and crochet work.

Hope this book will help you in the time of need, as well as give you a lot of pleasure pursuing your goals.

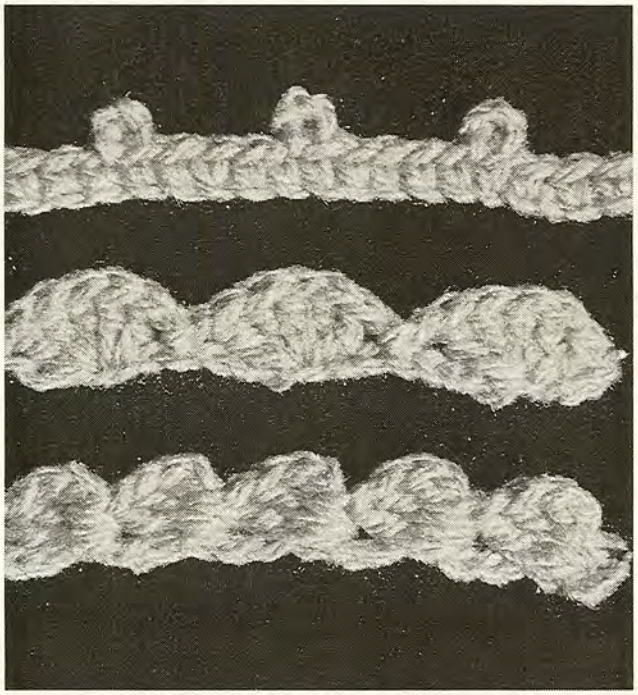
Best always,

Jodie

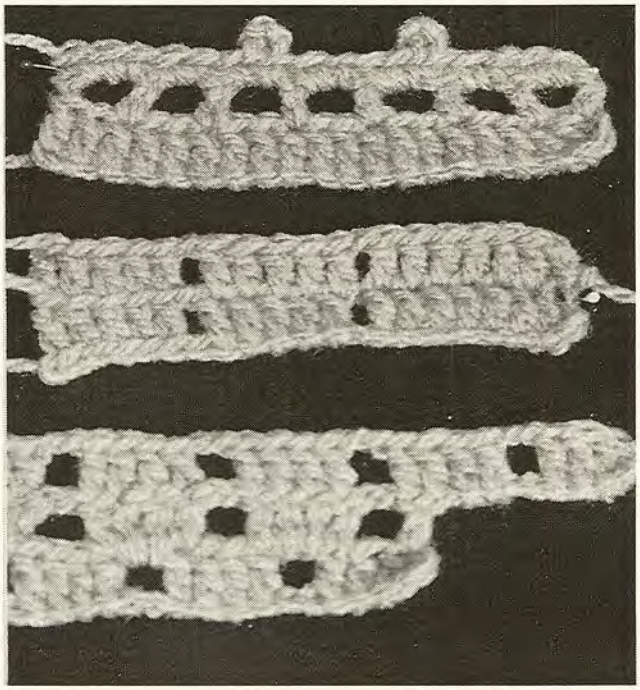
Crochet Chain
Slip Crochet on Chain
Single Crochet on Chain



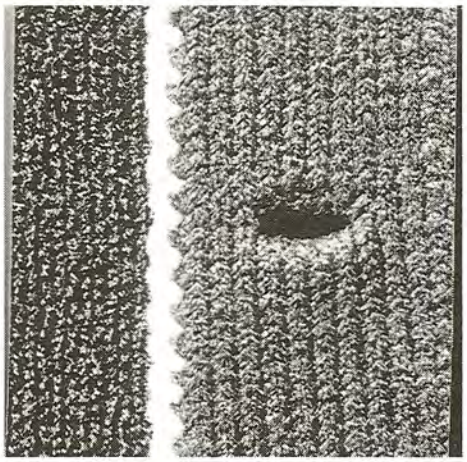
Half Double Crochet on Chain
Double Crochet on Chain
Triple (Treble) Crochet on Chain



Small Picot on Double Crochet
Small Scallop on Chain
Small Shells on Chain



Insertion - Filet on Double Crochet
Different Insert of Hook
Increasing & Double Crochet Filet



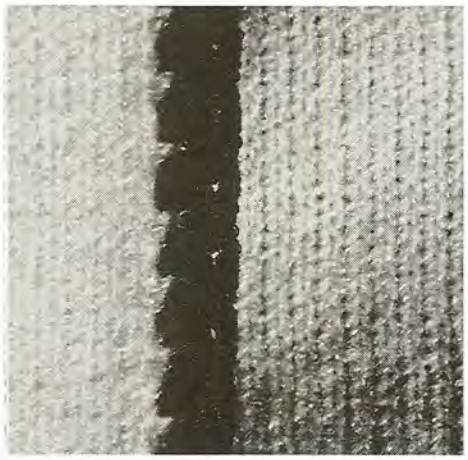
Crab Stitch Edge

Double Crochet Hem

Single Crochet Edge

Small Picot Edge

Shell Edge



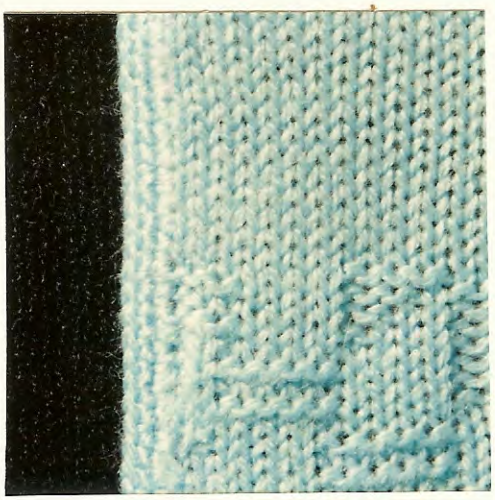
Crochet Braid Trim

Shell and Insertion

Elastic Casing

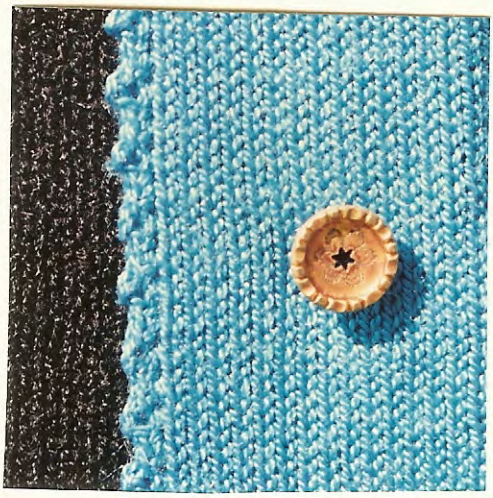
Taller Picot Edge

Crab Stitch Edge



Double Crochet Edge

Single Crochet Edge

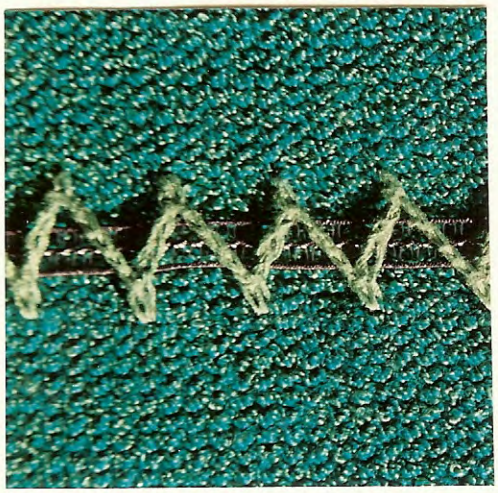


Small Picot Edge

Shell Edge

Crochet Braid Trim

Shell and insertion



Elastic Casing

Taller Picot Edge

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CROCHET LANGUAGE

The Crochet stitch begins with a slip loop of a strand of yarn or cord. Using a crochet hook, a new loop of yarn is pulled through the first loop. By adding loops and pulling them through different places and in different amounts, the pattern variations of crochet stitches are produced. Believe me, it's easy!

But first we must learn the crochet language and all the abbreviations used, in order to read and understand the patterns. The stitches have never changed over the years, but the language has. Below are three different versions. If you are using a pattern from any source other than an American author, then probably the English Guide should be used. Canadian, English, Australian, and many other countries always have one more throw of the yarn over the crochet hook than American patterns - e.i. Single Crochet in American is a Double Crochet elsewhere. If your pattern doesn't look like the example, maybe it is not written with the American language. If you are working in a very old book of vintage patterns of the early 1900's, check the graph below. These tables should help you with the differences.

AMERICAN		ENGLISH	
ch	chain stitch =	ch	chain stitch
sc	single crochet =	d c	double crochet
hdc	half double crochet =	h tr	half treble
dc	double crochet =	tr	treble crochet
tr	triple crochet =	dble tr	double treble
dtr	double triple crochet =	tr tr	triple treble
sk	skip		
st	stitch =	st	stitch
sl	slip		
sl st	slip stitch =	sl st	single crochet
y.o.	yarn over hook =	wrh	wool round hook

"Triple" means the same as "Treble"

Stitch Names used in Vintage Patterns are different with the terminology now. As you will see below, many overseas magazines will be using the "ENGLISH" or the "BEFORE" language. American authors will talk in the "AMERICAN" or "NOW" stitches.

NOW		BEFORE	
sc	single crochet =	d c	Double Crochet
dc	double crochet =	t c	Treble Crochet
half dc	half double crochet =	h t c	Half Treble Crochet
tr	treble crochet =	d t c	Double Treble Crochet
dtr	double treble crochet =	l t c	Long Treble Crochet

SAME LANGUAGE

beg	beginning	pat	pattern
rnd	round	rep	repeat
tog	together	rem	remaining
inc	increase	dec	decrease
lp	loop	sp	space
R.	row	P or pi	picot

One basic rule in following patterns of knitting, or crochet work, is to read the entire pattern through once. When you begin working the pattern, just read the first sentence - and do that. Read to the next period and do that. By working one sentence at a time, the pattern will unfold correctly. If you try to read too far, or second guess the writer, things usually go astray. If there are parentheses or asterisks, work each of these separate instructions by themselves - as many times as written before proceeding on to next part of the pattern.

Other wording in crochet patterns include phrases like "Work Even" or "Work Straight". This means to continue doing the same pattern stitch without increasing or decreasing until another direction is given.

"Parentheses" () are used a lot with these patterns. The directions in the parentheses () will be repeated a designated number of times given in the pattern, or across a specific row.

"Asterisks" * designate a certain set of instructions that must be repeated a given number of times. At the beginning and ending of a series of directions you will see "*". Whatever is in between the *'s should be repeated the number of times stated.

"Multiple of Stitches" is the basic number of stitches required for each pattern unit. Whatever number of stitches you need for a garment or trim must be divisible by the pattern unit. Sometimes you will need a "Multiple - Plus One (or two, etc.). The patterning will not come out correct unless you begin with enough stitches to make up this multiple number unit and/or the extra stitches (plus one, etc.). Divide the pattern unit number into the entire amount of stitches to be used. It should come out even unless you need the plus stitches. Then they should be added into the total amount of beginning stitches.

CROCHET HOOKS

Crochet hooks are made in different materials and sizes. There are sizes from very small steel hooks for sewing thread and fine yarns - to large plastic and aluminum hooks used with very heavy yarns and cords for afghans and rugs. There are even some old, precious bone, ivory, and wooden hooks to be found that crochet so smoothly they are a joy to use. The problem of these old hooks is that you can rarely find a size on them. But after using them for awhile, one finds the right one for intended use.

There are other types of crochet hooks such as the "Pick" from the knitting machine (looks like a dentist tool on one end and a hook on the other). Another hook is a double ended crochet tool used a lot for afghans and other specialty work. There is a long hook with a stopper on the one end for another, interesting type of crocheting. And, there is even a flexible Hook with a plastic cord attached to help in making large bulky items. So, this means your hook should fit your need of the moment. It is nice to have a complete set of each type of crochet hooks, so the right size is available (especially late at night). The sets make a terrific birthday or Christmas gift - you might want to drop some hints to

family and friends. Or, start your own collection. My bone, ivory, and few wooden hooks came from family hand-downs and antique stores. My hobby is collecting old, odd crochet hooks and knitting needles. Just think of all the beautiful items these old needles must have produced.

In working trims for my knits, I must confess that most of the time I just grab the "Pick" from the machine and begin. Even though I do have complete sets of all types of hooks, the "Pick" is always so handy. Having crocheted for so many years, by the feel of the stitch I can adjust the tension of my yarn to create the effect I want. More on tension just a little later.

However, when crocheting an article of definite proportions, you must have the correct size (a crocheted swatch), in order to complete the size you planned.

Steel Crochet Hooks are usually 5" in length and range in sizes by number from 00,0,1,2,3,4,5,6,7, 8,9,10,11,12,13, & 14. The higher the number, the smaller the hook. The highest number produces the smallest stitches.

Aluminum Crochet Hooks are usually 6" in length and range in sizes known by letters - B,C,D,E,F,G,H,I,J,K, and N. "B" is the smaller size producing the smallest stitches; "N" is the largest size in this type of hook and makes the biggest stitch. Sometimes these hooks are numbered 1 through 10-1/2 also.

Plastic Hooks come in different sizes. Some are 5-1/2", 9" or 14" in length. They are numbered from 1 through 10 and letters B through G as well as P & Q. These hooks do become warm in the hand and are the less desirable hooks to use. However, they have a place in crochet work.

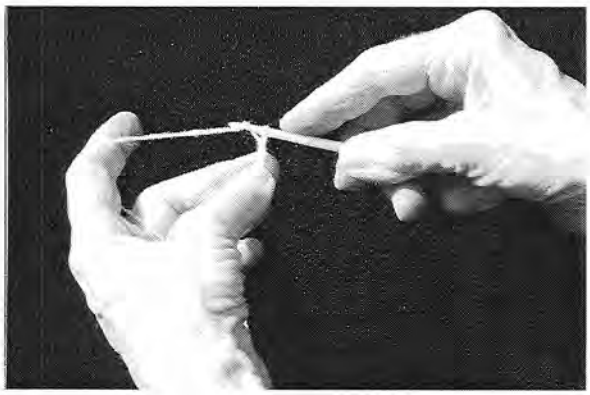
As for the bone, ivory and wooden hooks, one must make a swatch or do "trial and error". After awhile you will know which one will work best for certain stitches and yarns.

There are other crochet hooks for special crochet work. Crohook needles have hooks at each end and are great for working two colors of yarn at the same time. These are mostly Aluminum or Steel - 5", 6", 10", & 14" in length, and come in lots of sizes.

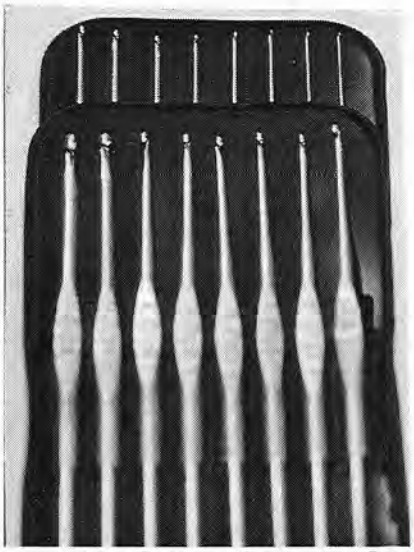
Afghan hooks come in two lengths - 9" or 14". They also are Aluminum. This has a hook on one end and a metal stopper on the other end. A lot of stitches can be placed on the needle without losing them off the other end. These hooks are for special work.

The Flexible Afghan Hook is different in that it has a long plastic cord with a stopper on the end attached to the hook. This holds lots of stitches for large items very easily.

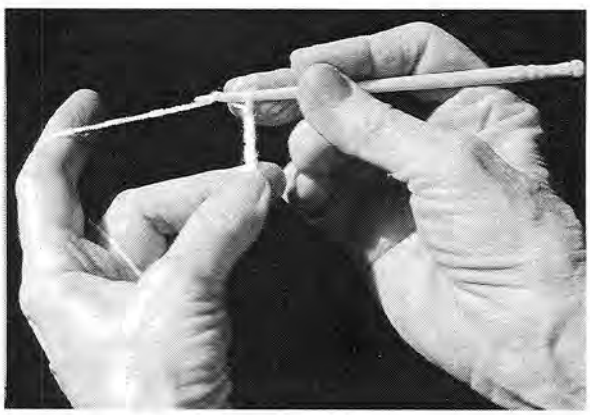
This book will only dwell on the basic crochet stitches and trims used on many of my knits. The information about other hooks is given to let you know there are many facets to crochet work. Crocheting has a beautiful history. Many traditional types of crochet are unique to different places in the world. Read up on this ancient art and enjoy some of the many beautiful pieces of crochet from the past and today.



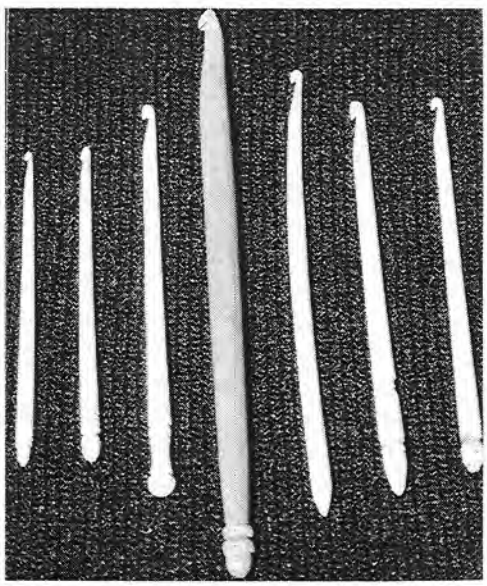
Hand Over Crochet Hook (Method 1)



Steel Crochet Hooks

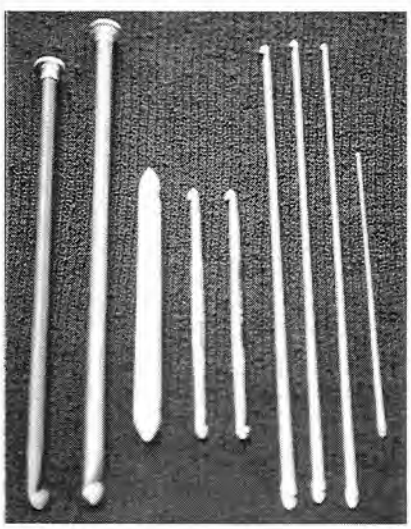


Hand Under Crochet Hook (Method 2)



Bone, Ivory, & Wooden Hooks

Aluminum Crochet Hooks



Afghan and Cro-Hooks

POSITIONS OF HANDS

There are two methods to hold the crochet hook. One way is to hold the hook in the right hand palm, with the back of the hand facing you. This is the easier way of manipulating the hook for beginners. It is slower because your wrist does not get into the action. As one becomes a better and faster crocheter, this method becomes rather awkward. If you want to start out this way, it is alright. But try and master the second method as soon as possible.

The second, and much better way in my opinion, is to hold the hook between the right thumb and first and second fingers. The thumb and the middle finger fit on the flat service of the hook where the size is usually imprinted. The hand is completely under the hook. This allows free wrist movement to throw (wrap) the yarn around the hook.

The left hand will control the yarn and the tension. The best way for me to do this is to bring the yarn up from below the little finger. Wrap the yarn once around the little finger from the inside to the outside. After the wrap, bring the yarn up inside the next two fingers. Bring the yarn between the first and second fingers and up over the first finger from the outside. Hold the yarn between the middle finger and the thumb. This hand will hold the fabric.

Next, make a loop with this yarn against the middle finger. Holding the crochet hook in the right hand, you are now ready to start to make the chain stitch into a chain (a basic stitch).

See Page 8 for photographs of the hands.

BASIC CROCHET STITCHES

BASIC CHAIN: Chain stitch

This is the basic stitch for starting crochet work from scratch. If you are placing crochet on a garment, this will not be needed as a foundation. We have another stitch for that. The chain does need to be learned, and understood.

Insert the hook through the loop made on the middle finger of right hand or into a slip knot on the beginning of the yarn.

* Place yarn coming up from the left hand over the hook. Using the hook, pull this yarn through the first loop on hook for the first stitch.* Keep repeating the directions between the "*'s". Each time this is done, one chain stitch is made and one loop remains on the crochet hook. Keep the tension even as you pull a strand of yarn through each loop. Watch a long chain develop. You count each chain stitch to begin a crochet pattern.

SLIP STITCH: (English - Single Crochet)

This stitch is used in many ways - to join ends together, to move across a chain carrying the yarn to another place without showing another row of crochet, to fasten off ends, as the least inconspicuous way to stabilize an edge, to hide raw edges, and to draw in areas that have become too loose.

To Slip Stitch on a Basic Chain, or a row of Crochet, insert hook into the center of the second chain stitch from hook. (This will be under the top piece of yarn in each chain stitch.)

Place yarn over the hook, and draw this yarn through the chain stitch and the loop on the hook. This makes one Slip Stitch and leaves one loop on the hook. Again, insert hook back into center of next chain stitch, yarn over and pull the yarn back through the chain and the loop on the hook. Another Slip Stitch done. Work this Slip Stitch into each stitch of the foundation chain, or across a row of crochet as needed.

****

The next four explanations of stitches are basic stitches of all crochet work. Distinct patterns are different variations of these stitches. Each of the four are one process bigger, or taller, than the last. The difference is how many times the yarn in looped over and drawn through the other loops. We will start with the small (Single) and build up to a much larger Triple Crochet by crocheting loops off in sections.

SINGLE CROCHET: (English - Double Crochet)

On the basic chain, place hook in the center of the second chain from hook (under the top loop). * Yarn over the hook and draw the hook and yarn back through the chain (two loops are on hook now). Yarn over the hook again and draw yarn through the two loops on the hook. One Single Crochet stitch has been made and one loop remains on hook. Insert hook into next stitch. * Repeat this along the chain.

At end of row, or to begin a row on a garment - chain 1, turn work around so opposite side is facing you. Go into center of first single crochet next to chain (insert hook under the two top strands of stitch). This Chain 1 counts as first stitch of second row. It is necessary to keep the row at an even height.

HALF DOUBLE CROCHET: (English - Half Treble).

This stitch is next size taller than one above. One can use this any place you like, such as in a basic chain or placed on top of a row of single crochet. It is very versatile.

Crochet a basic chain. *Yarn over the hook. Insert the hook into the third stitch from hook on the chain, or next stitch of Foundation row. Yarn over the hook and draw the yarn through the chain stitch (3 loops are now on the hook). Yarn over the hook again and draw this yarn through all three loops on the hook. This makes a half double stitch, and one loop remains on the hook.* Continue this across, repeating instructions between *'s.

To turn or begin a row on a garment, chain 2 stitches, turn work around so opposite side is facing you, and then repeat above instructions. This chain will count as the first stitch in this row keeping the height even. Work last half double crochet in top of last chain stitch in row. You can place the hook into 2 strands or only the top strand of yarn on the stitch below.

DOUBLE CROCHET: (English - Treble)

This stitch is one size taller than the previous one. Chain three stitches to start from another row or an edge. * Throw yarn over the hook. Insert the hook in the third stitch of the basic chain or into the next stitch of the Foundation row. Yarn over the hook and draw yarn through next stitch, or chain, (3 loops on the hook). Yarn over the hook and draw yarn through only the first two loops. Two loops are left on hook. Yarn over the hook once again and draw yarn through the last two loops on the hook. This leaves one loop remaining on hook. * Repeat all this between the *'s across the row.

To turn, chain 3 and turn the work so opposite side is facing you. This counts as first double crochet on this new row. Repeat instructions into the next stitch, going into either the back strand of stitch or both top strands. Work last stitch in the turning chain of the row below.

TRIPLE (TREBLE) CROCHET: (English - Double Treble)

This is yet another size taller than the previous stitch. Chain 4 stitches to start from another row. * Wrap yarn around the hook two times. Insert the hook in the fourth stitch of the basic chain or next stitch of Foundation stitch. Wrap yarn over the hook and draw yarn through stitch or chain. Now four loops are on hook. (Yarn over hook again and pull yarn through first two loops.) There are three loops on hook now. Repeat between ()'s two more times. One loop remains on the hook.* Work Triple Crochets by repeating all instructions between the *'s across the row. Make the Triple Crochet in the top of last stitch of the turning chain.

INCREASING CROCHET WORK

Increasing in Crochet work is very easy. There are several methods to do this, depending on what you are working. In patterns that call for "Increases", the writer should provide instructions of how this should be done. Here are some ways.

1. Crochet an extra stitch in the same pattern you are making at each end of each row.
2. Crochet a stitch in the same place as one just finished evenly spaced across the row. Keep in same pattern.
3. To round corners there are a couple ways to do this.
   a. Crochet three stitches of pattern into the same corner stitch.
   b. Crochet one stitch of pattern into corner stitch. Chain 1, (sometimes 2 in fine yarns). Crochet one more stitch in SAME corner stitch. Just make it square off and keep the corner flat.
4. To increase several stitches at the beginning of a row, make a chain for as many new stitches as are needed, plus the necessary chain for the turning. Crochet back along this chain in pattern.

DECREASING CROCHET WORK

Decreasing again can be done in several different ways. The best thing is to try out each method and decide for yourself what looks best on that particular item.

1. Do not work a stitch in the first and last stitches below. (In garments this will give a slanted edge.)
2. Skip a stitch on chain, or previous row, evenly across. If you are decreasing lots of stitches, make sure you space the decreases in even increments or your work will not look right. It will pucker.
3. For Single Crochet decreases place hook in next stitch. Yarn over and draw yarn through (2 loops on hook). Insert hook into the next stitch and yarn over - drawing through another loop (3 loops on hook). Yarn over now and draw yarn through the remaining 3 loops on hook.
4. For Half Double Crochet - crochet the stitch until there are the 3 loops on the hook. Leave these 3 loops on the hook and insert hook into the next stitch. Yarn over and draw another loop through (4 loops on hook). Yarn over again and draw yarn through all 4 loops on the hook.
5. For the taller crochet posts (Double, Triple Crochet, or even taller stitches), work the first stitch till the last two loops are on the hook. Complete the second stitch (one loop from that stitch and two loops from first stitch on hook - 3 loops on hook now). Yarn over and pull yarn through all three loops to complete stitch.
6. To get across a chain, or row, without the pattern stitch, use the Slip Stitch in first stitch, make another Slip Stitch in next stitch. Continue on to the spot you want to be. Chain up the size of your pattern to start first row. Make pattern stitch in next stitch.

JOINING YARNS IN CROCHET WORK

It is always best to change to a new strand of yarn at the end of a row. Leave ends of both old and new yarn hanging. Knot them into a "Square Knot" and weave in ends at least one inch along the edges. Clip off excess.

Sometimes it is necessary to change yarn in the middle of a row. Especially this is true when working with several different colors of yarn, so here's how to do that.

I dislike knots in the middle of a row, so I prefer to take the new piece of yarn and lay it on top of the last crocheted row. With the OLD yarn I then work the next four or five stitches as usual - working over the new yarn. Cut off old yarn and pick up new yarn and move on. Weave in ends later.

Another way to work in a new yarn is to finish one stitch. Now, insert hook into the new stitch in row below, yarn over using the new yarn, and draw through a loop of new yarn. Finish stitch. On last yarn over, draw yarn through the last two loops (the last loop will be old yarn). Continue on with new yarn.

FASTENING OFF ENDS OF YARN

At the end of each row of crochet you have really three options:

1. Chain 1. Finish off the end of a row by cutting yarn with about a 4" tail. Yarn over the hook with this tail and pull the yarn end through the stitch. Weave in edge.
2. Connect beginning of crochet to end of crochet. Slip Stitch into the top of the beginning chain (or stitch).
3. Chain stitch up, turn work over to opposite side, and continue working across the top of previous row.

The height of the chained post must be the same height of the stitch being used. If the chain is too short, the work will curl in or pucker. If the chain is to long for the stitch being worked, the edge will be loose, ruffle, bow out, or roll. Try this guide:

Chain 1	- Single Crochet Rows
Chain 2	- Half Double Crochet Rows
Chain 3	- Double Crochet Rows
Chain 3 or 4	- Triple Crochet Rows

SIMPLE VARIATIONS CREATED BY PLACING THE HOOK

Every stitch forms something that looks like a "V" along the top. If you insert hook into the top part of stitch, you will get one look. A ridge of yarn appears across row. If you insert hook into the bottom part of the stitch (under top two strands of yarn), you get another look.

When you are working across a previous row, you have the option of either of the above choices - plus one more. You may insert the hook into the center of the stitch below. It gives another look. Many patterns rely on where the hook is inserted; it does make quite a difference. Experiment and see about this.

LEFT HANDED CROCHETERS

Having left handed persons in my family, this has been quite a challenge to teach them crocheting, hand knitting, and machine knitting. After many futile attempts to turn around, working backwards, and every way but upside-down - the best way turned out the easiest.

PLACE THE BOOK, OR TEACHER, IN FRONT OF A MIRROR.

The student looks into the mirror and does NOT watch the demonstrator, or the book. Try this and see if it works for you. The mirror reverses everything for the left handed person. In the case of machine knitting, most of us learn to latch took bind off and double needle bind off from both directions. The left handed machine knitter is more comfortable to start working patterns from the opposite end of machine than usually called for. Don't give up. Give this method a try.

HINTS TO HELP

Crocheting techniques add so much to our machine and hand knitting. Here are some tips that I have enjoyed.

1. Slip, or Single Crochet, across sagging shoulder seams, across droopy necklines, or floppy cuffs of knits.
2. Crochet yarn with an extra strand of elastic thread across loose seams that still need to expand.
3. Try to knit in a Garter Bar Turn Edge when you plan to crochet an edging. Makes a great marking row.
4. If you want to crochet a decorative trim on a garment, knit in one marker cord row (yarn & cord together in same feeder) so you can easily pick up stitches and keep your crochet row straight.
5. Make a basic crochet row of HALF DOUBLE CROCHET around edges of a knit (along edges, around cuffs, collars, necklines, & hems). It will make a straight line on the inside, not the "V" line of a single crochet stitch.
6. Everyone crochets a different stitch. Your crochet will be unique. No one can pick up someone else's work and continue on with it and not show the difference. A lot of this is from the twist of the hands and wrists. Also the tightness of the fingers and feeding of the yarn changes the appearance of one's crochet.
7. Crocheting adds a great deal of "Finishing" to a knitted garment. It can be overpowering, so I like to keep the crochet simple. Try to suit the type of crochet to the lines of your garment. A tweed or patterned garment would look best with a small crochet finish. By the same token a very simple knit is a perfect place to do some very noticeable crochet work.
8. Handwork, such as crochet, can personalize knits a great deal. The enhancement of special trims makes an ordinary outfit look very expensive and exclusive.
9. Crocheting can put money in your pocket. And, it is fast, fun, creative handwork that many will pay for.
10. If you make a mistake with the crochet, check it out. It just might be very attractive and a new trim. That's how all these patterns were made before sometime, somewhere - good old "trial and error".
11. In working across a chain, don't let it twist. Keep it flat with the stitches facing you.
12. Block all crochet work from the wrong side of the fabric. This will help it retain it's depth and beauty.
13. If you have crocheted picots, shells, or scallops - try pulling the points out before pressing. Looks better.
14. Use old swatches for crocheting. The steamed yarn does not show in crochet. Helps the yarn barrel and saves good yarn for other things like more knits and crochets.
15. If you don't like the stitch because it's too loose or too tight, try another size crochet hook. It's up to you.

CHAIN CROCHET ELASTIC CASINGS

When knitting a Waistband, or Cuff, of a machine knit - put in a marker cord row with your garment yarn 4 rows before the waistline or cuff row AND 4 rows after the same point.

After garment is blocked and assembled, take a crochet hook and a single strand of matching thin yarn or cord. Attach a loop to garment at the side seam at bottom row marker cord. Chain 5. Slip stitch the chain into the 3rd stitch of the top marked row. Chain 5 again. Count over 5 stitches on bottom marked row from where the yarn was attached and Slip stitch this chain into that marked stitch. Chain 5. Return to top marked row, count over 5 stitches, and Slip stitch the chain into that marked stitch.

Continue in this manner until you have gone around the entire waistband, or cuff. Slip stitch last stitch to beginning stitch to complete row. This is a triangle looking casing to thread your elastic through. The elastic will not be sewn into your garment. Makes it easy to replace and does not pinch the fabric. Use 1" elastic. For narrower elastic, work the same way but put the marker rows closer together and use fewer stitches in chain. This does not show on right side of garment, but does a terrific job holding. It takes a lot of weight off the skirt, and stops the droops. Belts can be worn over this casing without notice.

SINGLE CROCHET EDGING

After a garment is blocked and assembled, the Single Crochet will give a "Finished Edge" to garments. I like to use a Garter Bar Turn Row as the foundation for this on skirt hems, slack hems, cuffs, & collars. It is a very good edge for sideways knitting also.

Using the machine pick, or a crochet hook, and one strand of yarn - attach yarn to garment and chain 1. Single Crochet into next stitch and almost every other stitch along this edge. Keep the work flat. This means that every once in awhile you must skip 1 stitch. If the crochet puckers in a little, that's okay. It will press out fine. Just don't let it flare out. Getting a smaller hook or putting a little more tension on the yarn will help you adjust this, if it happens.

This trim can be done from the right or wrong side of any garment. If done from the wrong side of garment, it may roll to the inside somewhat, and that's usually good. The appearance of the front and the back side of this stitch is different. Try both ways to see which side you want for the outside stitch.

Continue around the edge in Single Crochet pattern. Slip Stitch the edging together into beginning Chain stitch. If you would like to do several rows of this (even with contrast yarn), chain 1 after the connection is made to the first stitch and then continue another row. Remember, placing the hook into the top strand of lower stitch produces one look. Placing hook through both strands of lower stitch produces another look.

HALF DOUBLE OR DOUBLE CROCHET EDGING

These edges are used the same way as the one above. I always use a Half Double Crochet as my Foundation row. I just like the way it looks on the reverse side. The Half Double Crochet makes only one post, instead of the "V" of the single crochet on the back side of work. Look at your famous name garments and see what they are using. Try this and see the difference.

The Double Crochet Edging is great around Sideways skirts. Often I put a row of Single crochet and then another row of Double Crochet on these skirts to give the hemline some weight.

Use all of these crochet rows in combinations of sizes and colors to fit your needs. The possibilities are endless.

SMALL PICOTS

This is a beautiful trim if you have a Tuck edge on your knit. Slipped stitches make the distance between the Picots. The size (or height) of the Picot is determined by the number of stitches in the Chain.

First, do a foundation row of Single Crochet around the edge of your garment. Slip stitch beginning of the row to the end stitch to fasten them together. Chain 1. Do not turn the work.

* Slip stitch in each of the next 2 stitches, Chain 4 to make the Picot. Slip stitch into the first stitch of the Chain. This forms picot.* Repeat between *'s to end of row. Slip stitch beginning chain together with the last loop.

SMALL SCALLOPS

This is a nice soft edge for lace work and dainty things. Crochet a Foundation row of Single crochet around the edge of garment. Slip stitch the end stitch into the beginning chain. Chain 1. * Slip stitch into 1 stitch, miss the next 2 stitches, crochet 5 Double crochets all into the next stitch, miss 2 stitches.* Repeat this until you have completed a round. Slip stitch the beginning to the end. Make sure you keep the pattern even. This can be used with Foundation rows of your choice.

SHELL STITCH

Another nice edge with a soft touch. Again, crochet a Foundation row of Single Crochet around the edge of the garment, working from the wrong side. Slip Stitch the beginning edge to the last stitch. Chain 3. Turn work to outside.

Miss 1 stitch and Slip Stitch the Chain into next stitch. (A little circle is formed.) * Chain 2. Double Crochet three times into that little circle. (This looks like four posts in the circle.) The last Double Crochet must lay down along the previous row. At the point on the previous row that the loop on the hook sits, Slip crochet the loop on your hook into that stitch, to keep the Shell in position. (This will be 2 or 3

stitches missed - whatever keeps it flat.) * Repeat this as far as necessary. Remember, if you Slip stitched this loop across two stitches the first time, do this the remainder of the row. If it was 3 stitches, then do 3 stitches every time.

CROCHETED BRAID TRIM

This trim can be worked from a Garter Bar Turn Row, A Single Crochet Foundation Row, open stitches held on scrap yarn and ravel cord, or into rows of stitches. Usually this is worked with three strands of yarn at the same time. Two strands are used if the trim is made to come over the body area on a skirt.

Block and assemble the garment. I use the pick of the machine and three old blocked swatches for the crochet yarn.

With wrong side of garment facing you, * pick up 2 stitches at the same time (regard them as one stitch) with crochet hook - from open stitches in the ravel cord, garter bar stitch edge, or row edge. Single crochet these two stitches off with all three strands.* Continue around using method between the *'s.

To turn a corner, Single crochet in end stitch, Chain one, and then place another Single crochet in the same stitch as before.

At the end of first row, Chain 1, and turn work over to the outside. Single Crochet into each of the Single crochet stitches - going under the two top strands on row before. (Insert hook into the center of previous stitch). Pull last loop through and tie off strands of yarn. Steam flat.

If you are working this stitch on a skirt and want to crochet up a seam with this pattern, use only two strands of yarn up the seam. Pick up the third strand of yarn and crochet around the hem using the usual three strands.

To attach the seams that have crocheted work on each side, Slip Stitch them together from the back side of the garment.

Don't forget if you are using waste yarn and ravel cord AND have sewn seams together, there are open stitches in the seam. Catch them or you will lose some stitches with the ravel is gone.

CRAB STITCH (BACKWARDS CROCHET)

This is a great edge for tailored garments. While it takes a little time to get the hang of this, it is worth the effort. This can be worked straight on the garment, or over a foundation of Slip Stitch or Single Crochet. Try both.

The difficulty with this stitch is you work from the opposite end than normal. Your garment would be behind your hook instead of in front of it. Attach yarn to garment from the other end you would usually start - and Chain 1. * Turn the hook back and insert hook into next stitch behind where you are now. Yarn over and draw a loop through (2 loops on hook). Yarn over. Draw yarn through these two loops (one loop remains on hook).* Repeat between *'s around the edge, trying to keep the work smooth and even. It will appear as a nice cording on the work.

INSERTION (FILET, BEADING)

This stitch is used as lace work and can be made in multiple rows with beautiful effects. It can be done in any size stitch (Single, Half Double, Double, Triple, etc.). The stitch can be filled in some places and left open in others to create unique patterns that suit just you.

This stitch is also used if you want to thread a ribbon, put in elastic, or even beads, fur, etc. into a knitted garment. Here are the directions for this:

Crochet a Foundation stitch of your choice (Slip Stitch, Single Crochet or whatever) across the area you want to put in some insertion.

At the end of the Foundation Row, Chain 5 to turn work around. (Watch the side of garment you start on. You might want to begin with the wrong side, so your Insertion work with be on the outside. This is true in all your crochet work unless you are crocheting round after round and joining the rows with a Slip stitch.)

Wrap yarn around hook once. Insert hook into the top of the fourth post of Foundation row. Draw yarn and hook through stitch. Three loops are on hook now. Yarn over hook again and draw yarn through first two loops. Yarn over once more and draw yarn through last two loops. This completes a Double Crochet. * Chain 2. Skip 2 stitches on the Foundation Row. Work another Double Crochet in top of next stitch. *

For wider spaces to handle larger ribbons and items, use a Triple Crochet and skip 3 stitches, instead of the Double Crochet and skipping 2 stitches. For very narrow items, use Half Double Crochet and skip only one stitch. Work with this technique for awhile and then you will know exactly what you need to do to get the right size for your trim.

In the sample, Double Crochet was used and then one row of Picot was crocheted across the next row to finish this off.

CROCHET EDGES FOR ZIPPERS

While keeping the edge of your opening straight, try a row of Single Crochet around the place for a zipper before you sew the zipper into a garment. This technique is also very good to strengthen the edge of pockets, or openings, that usually are subjected to stress. It is a handy way to fix a lot of things.

It is best, in my opinion, to work the Single crochet from the wrong side of the garment. This makes a better looking finish on the outside of the garment for this work. Make sure to keep both sides equal length. It seems that often when we crochet "down" one side and then "up" the other side, one side becomes longer than the other. The only cure I know for this is to rip out the last crocheted side and do it again until both sides match. It happens to me all the time.

Using this technique is also very good around the neckline of "Boatneck" or "Batteau" garment. Helps it keeps it's shape.

CROCHETED BUTTONS

Purchase a card of flat headed plastic or shell buttons that have a small shank underneath for sewing on the buttons. Any size you wish will work. There are usually six or eight buttons on the card. I like the 3/8" or 1/2" size. Using the crochet pick from machine, chain 3, slip together to form loop. Chain 1.

Row 1. In loop, single crochet 6 times. Slip crochet in first stitch to join. Chain 1. DO NOT TURN WORK AROUND.
Row 2. * 2 single crochet in 1st stitch. 1 single crochet in next stitch.* Continue from *'s around circle. Join with slip stitch. Chain 1. Keep work flat.
Row 3. ** single crochet in 1st stitch. 2 single crochet in next stitch.** Continue from **'s around circle and join again with slip stitch. Chain 1.

Repeat this until you have a circle the size of the head of your button. Then start to make the circle curl inwardly by not increasing on next row.

Row 4. 1 single crochet in every stitch. (no double sts.) Join with a slip stitch. Chain 1.
Row 5. Single crochet in every-other-stitch. Slip stitch together. Chain 1. Insert button head into this circle.
Row 6. Start closing the crocheted circle around the button shank by tightly crocheting slip stitches into every other st. Repeat Row 6 again if needed.

Draw the circle completely together underneath - with the shank exposed to allow you to sew on the button. Tie off yarn. Make as many buttons as needed for your outfit.

BLOCKING CROCHET WORK

It is best to block crochet work from the wrong side. This will prevent crushing the stitches too much, especially if you have shells, or braid, in the work.

For the Single Crochet on the edges of garments, I don't worry about that too much. These just need to be pressed flat. In the case of trims that have picots, or points on the edges, sometimes one must pull them out. I use my fingers or a dull pin to shape the points. If you have crocheted square corners on collars or cuffs, make sure the iron flattens them out to look square on both sides. Nothing is worse than seeing one side of a collar real sharp and the other side sort of "rounding the bend". Try and keep them the same.

Treat crochet as you would a knit. The crochet stitch will be more easily pulled and stretched in different directions. The construction of the crochet stitch allows this. If I machine wash and dry my knitted garment, the crochet trim will be in there too. This has not caused any problems so far.

SWATCHES FOR CROCHET

While you are learning to crochet and using this book for the trims, swatches are not that important. As they say, "Beauty is in the Eye of the Beholder". Only you need to be satisfied when you are embellishing your knits with a trim. If the crochet looks like you want it, that's all that needs to be said.

However, if you plan to make a crochet garment of some sort, then you must make swatches - just as in knitting.

In Crochet Work, it is the size of the hook and the feel of the yarn in your hands that changes the tension of the fabric. It is most important to get the crocheted fabric to be correct with the pattern writer's gauge, or you will not crochet the size stated in the pattern. This means you must reach the same number of rows and stitches per inch as the pattern calls for, or your article will not come out the size you wanted. It will be too large, too small, or not look like the pattern stitch in the picture. Remember, being off the gauge just a trifle adds up across a row. So, at the end of the row you could be off as much as 3 or 4 inches. The same thing is true with the height of a pattern stitch. The gauge must be correct.

All is not lost in making a gauge. You will be learning a new pattern probably. You will be getting the feel of the hook and the yarn working together. Could be that you don't like making that particular pattern, and found that out by making the gauge.

Take the specific hook the pattern calls for and chain about 4 inches. Work back across this chain in the chosen pattern. Keep crocheting rows until you have approximately 4 inches in height.

Lay this swatch out flat. Set an iron with a teflon sole plate attached - down on the swatch with steam flowing. Do not permit the iron to stretch the stitches. After blocking is completed, place a ruler on the Swatch and count the number of rows it takes to crochet 2" in height. Count the stitches needed to crochet 2" across. These must be the same stitches and rows per inch to match pattern. If this does not match, then change and work another Swatch with a different size hook. A larger hook will give you less stitches and rows. A smaller hook will give you more stitches and rows.

Let's hope this helped. If it is too difficult to come up with the correct Swatch by changing the hook, then try crocheting a Swatch by not wrapping the yarn around as many fingers as normal (easing the tension of the yarn). Sometimes though a Swatch is an impossibility with the yarn you have chosen and it's easier to switch ideas. A few times the pattern will not hold it's shape correctly with a selected yarn.

It could be that you could use a Swatch that is not quite right on the Stitch Gauge. Just make a size larger or smaller, especially if it is for a "growing person".

Check out the Knitting Machine Swatch. There are answers to a lot of Crochet Swatch problems written there. Well, good luck with your crocheting. If you have any problems, I'll see you around at some seminar and we can try to straighten them out.

EASY SWATCH FOR KNITTING MACHINES

The "Swatch" is the basis of correct knitting and pattern design. If a pattern stipulates so many stitches and so many rows per inch, you MUST find a way to knit these numbers of stitches and rows equalling an inch in order to knit the size you wish. By changing your carriage dial and/or the upper antenna dial, this can be accomplished. We call this getting the correct "STITCH GAUGE" and we do this by making "SWATCHES".

What a pattern writer is saying to a knitter is, "If you knit this pattern with the correct STITCH GAUGE, you will end up with the size the writer stated - and the size you chose". On the other hand, if you knit the designer's pattern with any other Stitch Gauge or an incorrect Swatch - all bets are off as to what size you will end up knitting. This is why Stitch Gauges and making accurate Swatches are so important. It is the very foundation of knitting accuracy and enjoyment.

I don't like making Swatches either. After years of struggling through hundreds of Swatches, this is the best way I have found to get this chore completed. So, let's get on to the understanding of this basic function. We will do it the easy way and move on to the fun of making some classy knits.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS ABOUT SWATCHES AND STITCH GAUGES

1. Why make a Swatch in the first place?
   a. It makes the difference between successful knitting and total disasters. Patterns are written so if you knit at a certain tension that gives the pattern gauge stated in the pattern, you will make the size garment described.
   b. The Swatch must be worked in same pattern, or patterns, as garment is to be knitted - that is Fairisle, Lace, etc.
   c. A new Swatch must be knitted when using a different dye lot of same yarn and color.
   d. Every machine is different. If you have two machines, mark which machine was used to make the Swatch. One cannot switch, or mix, machines and Swatches.

2. Where does one start to knit a Swatch with a new yarn?
   a. Ask your dealer or yarn vender what tensions do they recommend for a particular yarn.
   b. Some yarns have estimated tensions on their labels.
   c. Trial and error by knitting and feeling the yarn to decide on your choice of texture of the Swatch. This is called arriving at the "Hand of the Yarn" you wish.
   d. Before long you will know just about where to set your dials to knit your favorite yarn. But still knit a swatch to make sure.

3. Get the stitches correct, then work with the rows.
   a. Stitches are mainly changed by the dial on the carriage.
   b. Rows can be changed by turning the antenna dial.
      (1.) Looser flow of yarn makes taller stitches - making fewer rows in one inch.
      (2.) Tighter tension on antenna dial makes shorter stitches - creating more rows in one inch.
   c. Make sure your yarn is not hung up anywhere on the cone or in the machine. It must flow freely.
   d. Check your carriage. Make sure your Lace or Tuck buttons (or brushes underneath carriage) are in correct position.

4. Temperaments of Two-Color, or Design Knitting.
   a. Fairisle, or two-color, knitting is usually about a full tension looser than stockinette for the same gauge.
   b. Lace knitting is about a full tension tighter than the stockinette gauge.
   c. Tuck stitches make very wide stitches but short in length.
      (1.) It is best to use a knit leader, knit tracer or radar on patterns of Tuck or Slip. Armhole or neckline shapings are hard to chart for a diagram in Tuck or Slip patterns.
   d. Slip stitches will knit a lot like the Tuck Stitches.
   e. These are general rules - one must make a Swatch for each type of knitting to be accurate.
   f. If you are combining any of the above types of knitting in a single garment, you must make Swatches for each and then change your dials when switching patterns.

5. Why put in the contrast rows of knitting in my Swatch?
   a. This makes sure the iron didn't distort the sample. Be careful and lay a ruler across this line of contrast knitting to determine the line is straight.
   b. To mark off the number of rows to be counted.

6. Why block Swatch - in some cases even wash and dry it - just as you plan to care for the garment?
   a. This tests the yarn for color fastness and washability.
   b. This will confirm your tension will remain correct.

7. DO NOT PIN OUT THE SWATCH WHEN BLOCKING. You want the yarn to do what it wants to at this time.
   a. I use a steam iron with a teflon soleplate and place it right on the swatch with steam flowing until the knit stays put and lays flat (no rolling even on edges).

8. Measuring the swatch for stitches & rows.
   a. Accurately measuring from correct places is the key.
      (1.) Measure for stitches BETWEEN MARKED contrast stitches. (Don't include the marked ones).
      (2.) Measure for rows from point of the "v" of main yarn to point of "v" on same stitch of the contrast yarn.

b. All the things my swatch can tell you.
   (1.) One of the two knitted Swatches may be correct. If first one is too small AND the second one too big, then use the tension in between the two knitted.
   (2.) If one of the two knitted swatches is "Almost" right but you would rather have the garment just a little bit larger, or smaller, then use the next dot (up or down) on the carriage.

9. Let the correct swatch "rest" overnight. Check before knitting to make sure the swatch has remained the same.

10. Since none of us enjoy making Swatches and detest the time and yarn needed to do this, take a hint from me. On a dreary day or a time when things are not going my way, I sit down and knit Swatches of all the yarns that are laying around waiting for me to create a "Gorgeous" garment. Might as well use the unhappy or boring time in doing something necessary. After I have blocked and checked the Swatches and know they are correct, I wrap the Swatch around the cone of yarn. Then when I am in the mood to knit and the creative juices are flowing, they will not be slowed down by making SWATCHES!

11. Recycling old, unwanted Swatches.
    a. Great source of yarn to crochet trims - just unravel the old Swatch as you crochet. Even if the Swatch has been previously blocked and steamed, it will not show.
    b. Use as basis for open stitches by hanging on needed number of stitches from Swatch. Then knit a ravel cord over these stitches so you can remove Swatch when finished.
    c. Use to try out new ideas and color combinations. Placing different colors next to each other often changes the hues and shadings of yarns.
    d. Practice different techniques, such as crochet trims or buttonholes.

PREPARATION OF MACHINE

After you have properly cleaned and oiled your machine, chosen your yarn and design, it is time to prepare the necessary Swatch or Swatches. Thread both the main yarn and contrast yarn correctly through the machine antennae which should be set at the middle settings. Do not place the extra tension wire on the contrast yarn's wire antenna. We shall talk about that later.

Set your carriage in the normal knitting mode. Make sure your brushes on and under your carriage are not engaged unless you want them that way. Set your tension dial on the carriage at an approximately normal setting for the yarn to be used.

Remember that one should knit in a smooth, relaxed manner. Fast knitting will tighten up the knitting, while too slow a pace will loosen the fabric. A nice, even, glide across the needles will create the best results. Never press down on the carriage handle as if ironing. This will also distort the stitches.

If you are fortunate enough to have more than one machine, be sure to mark, or code, which machine knitted the Swatch. By using the same contrast color for different machines is an easy way to differentiate between them.

If you are making a two color, or fairisle Swatch, the main yarn should be placed on the right side antenna on most machines. The contrast yarn should be placed on the left side of the antenna, as this side has an extra small wire which should be hooked onto this antenna wire. The reason for doing this is to keep the contrast yarn under a little more tension which will decrease the length of the floats, or loops, of the contrast yarn on the underside. Some machines will have this extra tension wire on both sides of the antennae. In this case you may place either yarn on which ever side you choose.

KNITTING THE SWATCH

THESE SWATCHES ARE MADE OVER 40 STITCHES. DO NOT USE ANY WEIGHTS OR CAST-ON COMB ON THIS KNITTING. PULL OUT TO HOLD (E) POSITION AND "E" WRAP FROM NEEDLE #20 (RIGHT) THROUGH NEEDLE #20 (LEFT). KNIT ONE ROW ACROSS ALL NEEDLES. PULL ALL NEEDLES OUT TO HOLD (E) POSITION AND KNIT 1 ROW ACROSS THREE MORE TIMES. THIS WILL KEEP THE STITCHES ON THE MACHINE. IT REALLY WORKS, BELIEVE ME.

This demonstration Swatch is for a gauge of 8 stitches by 11 rows equaling 1 inch (8 x 11 = 1"). For other stitch gauges, mark the needles outside the needed stitch gauge and knit the required number of rows between the contrast marker rows. ANY STITCH GAUGE CAN BE MADE WITH THIS METHOD OF MAKING SWATCHES.

Place the carriage on the right hand side of the machine and set the row counter to 000.

R.C. 000. With main color yarn "E" cast-on 40 stitches over needles #20 left and #20. Knit 10 rows even.

R.C. 10. Take out garment yarn and replace with contrast yarn. Knit 2 rows even.

R.C. 12. Take out contrast yarn and put in main color yarn. Knit 11 rows even.

R.C. 23. With two small pieces of contrast yarn, mark ndl. #9 left and #9 right by knitting each piece of yarn through these designated stitches. (This is for an 8 stitches to an inch gauge. Change the marked needle for other stitch gauges.)
After these 2 stitches are marked, continue knitting 11 more rows with main color yarn over all stitches.

R.C. 34. Remove main color yarn and put in contrast yarn. Knit 2 rows even over all stitches.

R.C. 36. Replace contrast yarn with main color yarn.
Knit 4 rows even.

R.C. 40. Put in picot holes to match dial setting.
Example: For tension of 4.2 XX XXXX
Place it backwards as you are working on wrong side.
Knit 4 more rows even over all stitches.

R.C. 44. Remove main color yarn and put in contrast yarn.
Knit 8 rows even over all stitches.

R.C. 52. Move tension dial on carriage two dots higher (looser).
Knit 8 more rows even over all stitches.

R.C. 60. Remove contrast yarn and replace with main color yarn.
Knit 10 rows.

R.C. 70. Remove main color yarn and put in contrast yarn.
Knit 2 rows.

R.C. 72. Remove contrast yarn and put in main color yarn.
Knit 11 rows.

R.C. 83. Mark ndls. #9 left and #9 right with contrast yarn
as above for 8 sts. to an inch gauge.
Knit 11 more rows in main yarn over all stitches.

R.C. 94. Remove main color yarn and put in contrast yarn.
Knit 2 rows.

R.C. 96. Remove contrast yarn and put in main color yarn.
Knit 4 rows over all stitches.

R.C. 100. Put in picot holes to match new dial setting:
Example: For 5.0 XXXXX
Knit 6 more rows even over all stitches.

R.C. 106. Latch tool bind off all 40 stitches.
Remove from machine and tube the swatch.

Purl side of Swatch

Knit side of Swatch